

will enable you to quickly switch hosts if you find your current host unsatisfactory. All you need to do is set up the new site, change the DNS pointers in your domain name, wait for a few days for the propagation (of the new IP address for your Web site) to take effect, and you'll be good to go.

1.3 Free Domains / Web sites

For those of you still undecided about spending money on setting up your own Web site, there is still the option of going in for a free site. Free sites have some limitations. Your site will be a sub-domain of the free site provider. Geocities (geocities.yahoo.com) and Google Page Creator (pages.google.com) are good examples of free Web site providers. Other than the “top-drawer” names, there are literally hundreds of companies that provide free hosting. The catch, though, is that they will reserve space on your screen to serve advertising banner ads and other links. Also, they might disable certain features that are processor intensive, and only allow you to have limited interactivity on the site.



Geocities Control Panel



Google Page Creator

If you are new to Web page design and not too keen on getting your fingers dirty by delving into HTML coding, most of these free Web sites (as also the paid sites) offer template-based WYSIWIG (What you see is what you get) interfaces that enable you to design your Web site using nothing more than your mouse and keyboard.